



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05775) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **60**
Responses Received: **59**
Response Ratio: **98.3 %**

Subject Details

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Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, January 26, 2026**

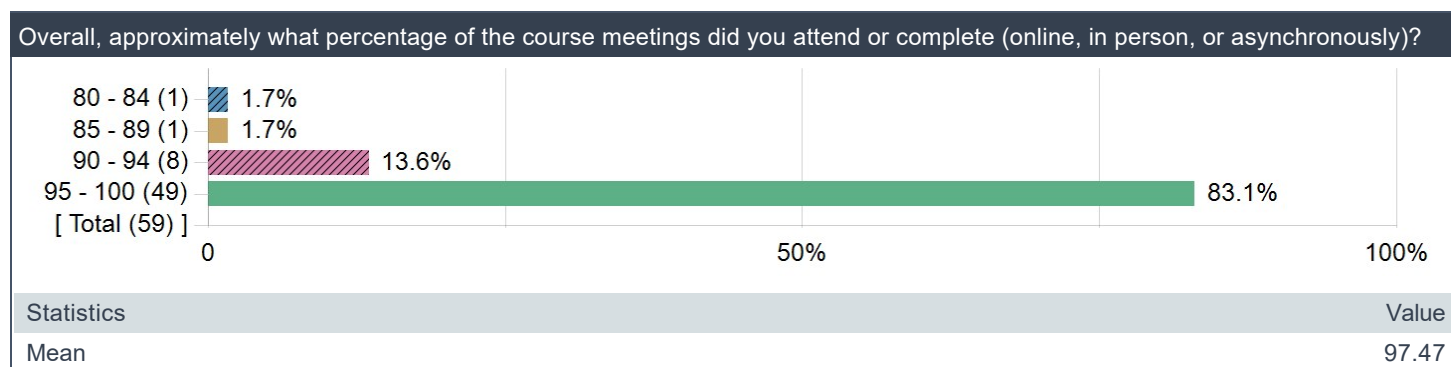
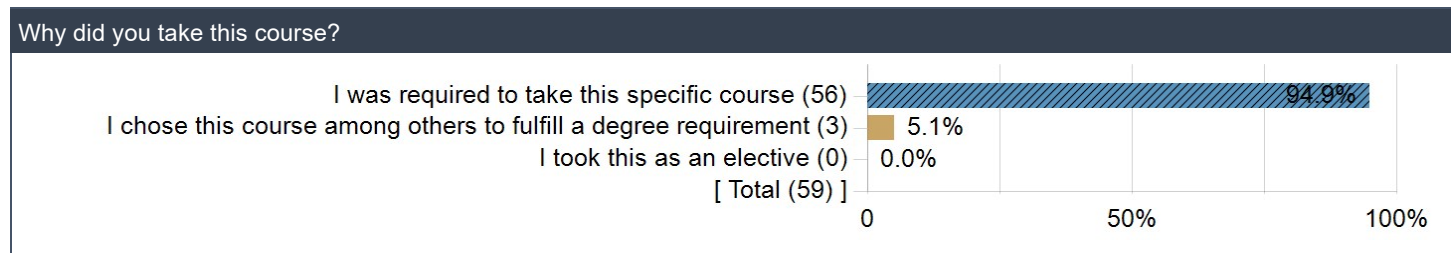
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	33.9%	50.8%	13.6%	1.7%	0.0%	59	4.17
The course was well organized.	32.2%	49.2%	8.5%	8.5%	1.7%	59	4.02
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	45.8%	40.7%	11.9%	1.7%	0.0%	59	4.31
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	55.9%	39.0%	5.1%	0.0%	0.0%	59	4.51
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	39.0%	42.4%	11.9%	6.8%	0.0%	59	4.14
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	28.8%	35.6%	22.0%	11.9%	1.7%	59	3.78
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	33.9%	50.8%	10.2%	5.1%	0.0%	59	4.14

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	33.9%	39.0%	27.1%	0.0%	0.0%	59	4.07
Overall, this course was	20.3%	44.1%	30.5%	5.1%	0.0%	59	3.80

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comment
The homework was effective in teaching me what I needed to know
Class Sessions and Homework
I thought doing the code together as a class was very helpful. Also, collaborating on quizzes helped me understand where my knowledge was lacking.
Lectures
I loved this class and everything about it
none
I think the lectures were very informative and the pace of the course was very good. I think the in class checks at the end were very informative.
Half of our lectures being dedicated to R–Studio only really helped, as it created a quick reference and note sheet for me to study. I also enjoyed the professor's humor, it made the 2 hour lectures more engaging.
The lab recordings effectively explained the content when I was confused or struggling to understand the material. In–class lectures and walking through coding the r–script together also was very informative.
He was very helpful setting us up well for the quizzes and being reasonable about homework assignments.
Most effective was the homework assignments that allowed for multiple attempts, which provided a greater understanding of the subject material
The actual lectures where we went through the code with examples was very helpful in learning.
The TAs are very helpful, and I like that recordings are posted since the class can move a little fast at times.
Going over examples/labs
The iterative homeworks
Most effective were teacher. He was so helpful and thoughtfully explained the material, also ensuring to answer the students questions.
I would say the homeworks, while challenging, were really helpful to learning.
Professor Bolfarine is extremely kind and cares for his students immensely. I can tell he has a genuine love for the course material and takes time to prepare for his lectures. I really appreciated the review videos each week as well.
Even though the class was long, the lectures were easy to follow and the homework helped enforce the learning.
The quizzes were good checks of understanding and the homeworks were reflective of the exams and course content. The lectures were very beneficial and well structured, being able to follow along with the code greatly helped with my understanding. The professor thoroughly explained all concepts.
The professors lectures as well as the recorded lectures posted on canvas are the most helpful. Additionally, professor Bolfarine's office hours were very helpful. He is an excellent professor.
the recordings online that i can watch
I liked the quizzes at the beginning of class I just wish they weren't factored into our grade as much and more of a check for understanding. I also liked how detailed professor bolfarine was while teaching.
I liked in the in–person R walk through and I liked doing the group quizzes.
Weekly quizzes + HW where you could see your answers helped me continuously learn the content.
Multiple tries on homework assignments, collaborative quizzes, and pre readings were all helpful to me. I felt like I had the opportunity to collaborate with my peers and really understand what was happening in the class.
He is very friendly and approachable for all questions in class. We go fairly deep into each topic.
The quizzes in class were helpful. It forced me to gain a deeper understanding of the topics we were learning week by week, which prepared me more for the exams.
Weekly homework's were useful in gaining understanding for the topic.
I think that the recorded labs and lectures were the most effective in helping me learn.
Prof Bolfarine was very nice in posting the slides and recordings on Canvas for us to review for our quizzes and exams.
the daily quizzes
Prof. Bolfarine was good at walking us through most of the concepts.

Comment
recorded lectures were great
Lectures were mostly helpful in that there were certain things I really didn't understand that parts of the lecture were able to remedy.
I believe the in class quizzes and following along with the practice and lesson were very helpful.
The homework's, quizzes and lecture allowed me to understand the statistics concept.
I liked the step-by-step R Studio direction
Provided presentations after the lecture, allowing us to use them for our respective homework.
The professor explained things well, and the slides were useful for study material.
the ta reviews and some of the lab recordings i do like that they give so many resources to help with this cours
The homework assignments were good practice for the concepts, and Professor Bolfarine was very accommodating.
I really liked that all the lectures were record and that everything was posted beforehand. I also appreciated the slides being posted and having a clear calendar on Canvas so I knew what we were doing in each class. I also liked the teaching style and how the prof walked us through the R script, he is really good at explaining how to do things and making confusing topics easy to understand.
I really think that even though the quizzes were challenging, they really helped test the knowledge. I also thought that the homeworks and how they are set up to building on your answers to get 100% makes you really think about the mistakes you made and how to address them. The professor is also very passionate and nice and made the class feel less hard.
The professor was engaging and provided material to check understanding and review throughout the course.
The homeworks allowed me to really dig deep and understand the material.
The content was paced well, and the homeworks/tests/quizzes were fair
N/A
Lectures
Posting the R codes that we did after class

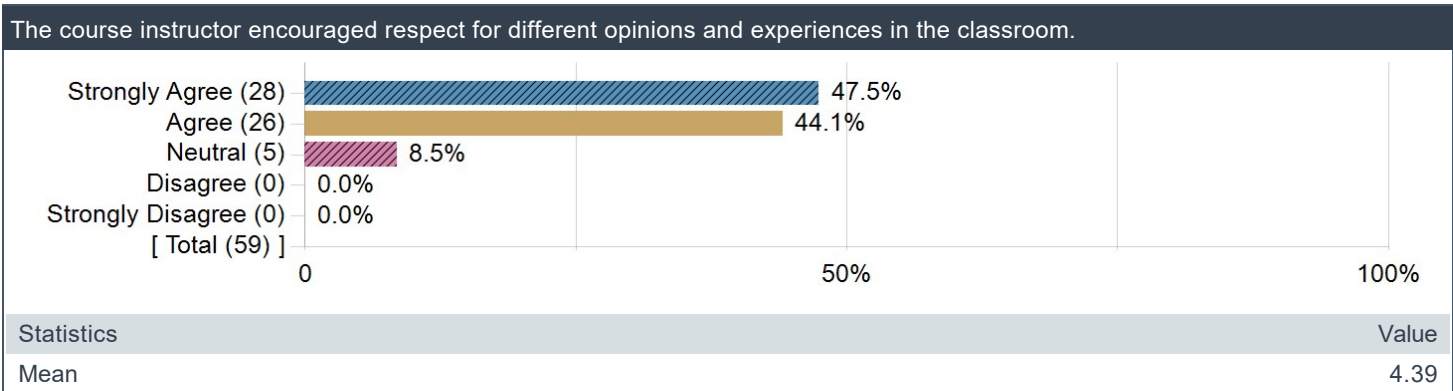
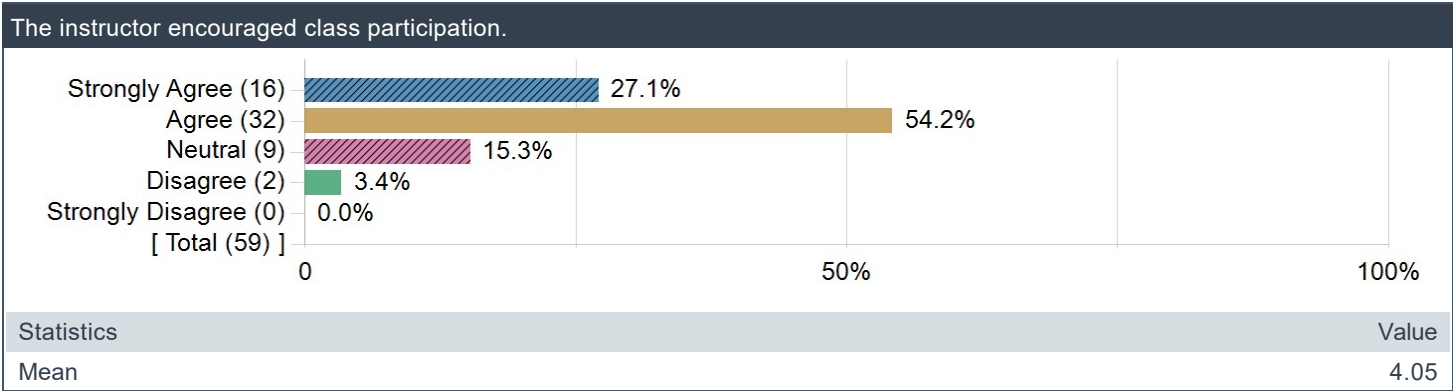
Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comment
The lectures, quizzes, and exams were very challenging. It might've been less if lectures were more structured and focused on concepts we'd need to know for exams.
I found the quizzes most challenging, as sometimes I felt that they covered content we had not discussed or tested over parts of the content that we didn't get very in depth to in the actual lectures
My primary pain point was the format of the test. I performed well, but I found the web browser R to be very difficult and buggy. I saw many students around me having to restart their code because the browser would shut down. I thought it was kind of annoying to never had used the web browser before the test.
Quizzes, workload
none
I think the quizzes every week were pretty challenging considering we only had this course once a week so it was hard to keep up with the content enough to take a quiz every week.
The biggest problem I had was the fact that the class usually ran long, making it difficult to reach my other classes in time. I would leave early, however the participation quizzes at the end make it more difficult to do so.
The in-class quizzes were very challenging and often contained questions that were strangely worded and thus ambiguous. I think allowing collaboration during these quizzes is a helpful way to make them more manageable while still assessing class comprehension of the content.
The quizzes are definitely the most challenging, but I appreciate the guidance they provide. Sometimes the homework did not completely help with the quizzes.
The aspect which I found most challenging was the lecture-style of the course as it was difficult to understand the underlying fundamentals of each lesson. My conceptual understanding took a backseat, as I focused on just the application of lessons instead of learning how each topic actually worked.
I think the most challenging part was the pre class quizzes because they were every single class and it was a little hard to review the last class' topic before every single week.
The entire course was pretty challenging to me, but the tests especially were hard even with open notes.
The in person quizzes. It was challenging because it requires you to apply information you just learned

Comment
The exams were tough sometimes, but as long as you study you should be fine.
Weekly quizzes. I liked how towards the end we got to work in groups.
I found that the most challenging part was following along in the last few weeks. It seemed repetitive yet really hard, and I think for the future doing more check ins during the lecture would keep it more engaging.
This course's pacing is illogical. The first half is like a Statistics 301 review, then the second half had numerous topics tested over that we are not covering in class. The professors need to all agree from the start what concepts will be tested over and spread out the difficult across the year. That way, students do not have to learn content for a homework, only to have it not be tested over. I often had to ask what content was important to learn. Statistics has a lot of application to business, so I was very disheartened to feel so constantly lost in this class. Professor Bolfarine always went over his allotted class time and rarely covered all of the content we needed to cover. The homework assignments often stretched beyond lecture content. Overall, I felt ill-equipped to handle the course's challenges.
The most challenging part was the tests. I think providing more practice exams might be helpful or maybe giving a review day.
The quizzes were challenging if you weren't prepared for class. The time limit made it difficult and because there were such few questions, getting a couple wrong had a big impact on your overall grade. I think it would be beneficial to go over the quiz answers in class after taking them so everyone fully understands and it would be good preparation for exams as well.
The daily quizzes were a bit challenging but they were helpful in studying for the exam.
the lectures were very long and not easy to follow, so doing the homework directly after was challenging
I found it challenging to keep up with the content being that there was only class once a week and for that time the content was taught mainly through a ppt presentation.
I did not like the perusal the instructions were vague.
I found the pacing of the course challenging as the homework often covered content we didn't get to in class. We would consistently go over time and still not get to everything. I think maybe decreasing some of the content (especially parts that aren't touched on in practice, only conceptually) could help.
I felt that the wording on some of the homework and exam questions was really difficult. I think that more practice problems similar to the exam would be helpful to understand the nuances and differences between the answer choices.
The slides are not extremely detailed, so trying to go back to learn lessons is hard. There are videos provided, but I wish there were also notes provided.
We got behind in some of the lectures, so cramming for some of the content in class made it difficult to learn at times.
The harder aspects of this course are all near the end, and the beginning is deceptively easy by comparison. Too much time is spent reviewing topics from STA 301, and too little time is spent on much more difficult topics, especially linear regression.
I think that the most challenging part of this course was how quickly it ramped up compared to the first 4–5 weeks. I do think that condensing some of the lessons early on would allow students more time to digest the more difficult and complex subjects.
One thing that was most challenging was understanding concepts. We would go over easier concepts longer than we needed while skimming over the difficult ones. It would've been better for students to go over the harder concepts to make we understood.
the test was pretty difficult, could have taught more things aligned to the test
I thought the teaching style was most challenging, as during class I did not feel engaged as the professor was just lecturing off of slides and inputting data into Rstudio, without thoroughly explain why/how/ or going deep into how these concepts worked and how it would translate into exam material.
Instructor had accent and was very repetitive, making it hard to stay engaged in lecture
The most challenging thing was that I had to do a lot of self-learning in the class. I think it could be a language barrier thing because English isn't my professor's native tongue.
The fact that it is a 2 hour course does make it difficult to maintain focus and the fact that we were a class behind also did not help.
The homework's were challenging and sometimes assistance was needed, it would help if the answer key or rsript for the homework's were released.
The midterm and quizzes were the most challenging for me
Found it kind of difficult to follow along in class, pretty much always extends class until after the allotted time, and doesn't finish the lecture
One thing that could be done in the future is he could organize and structure how his lectures are going to be in terms of time
Meeting once per week was a bit of a strange dynamic, and the overall layout of the course felt pretty disorganized. Some of the lessons felt pretty random and hard to track.
the second half of the semester is much more challenging content wise and adding new subjects to the curriculum was definitely hard to understand i believe the instructors need to clarify the most of the topics from the second half of the semester as they are

Comment
very dense and difficult compared to the first half.
The concepts themselves were occasionally hard to understand, and Professor Bolfarine was not always the best at explaining them. I would suggest pacing the class and lecturing better.
The quizzes were challenging, I wish they were not such a big part of our grade.
The challenging part is the content. We focus a lot on the coding that I sometimes cannot comprehend all the concepts of the course in its entirety.
Using webR was difficult on exams and made testing more stressful.
The first test used a web version of RStudio that is very clunky. Mine crashed 10 times during the exam and I felt cheated of my best performance because of it. This made the test very frustrating. I would suggest allowing students to use normal R during the test. In decision science, which requires students to use Excel during the tests, everyone joins a Zoom call and shares their screens to prevent cheating. I think the same system would work here.
The only challenging part of the course was taking the exam – lockdown browser was very buggy for me and ended up costing me 20 minutes of my testing time.
N/A
Test, better reviews
The tests were very difficult

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.